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iRumors 2014

All the speculation that's fit to print!

By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

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Apple's release schedule has been meticulously crafted to keep speculation and rumors circulating year round.

So what rumors have been circulating lately? Some you might expect, some you might not.

iPhone 6

Missing Plug-in 

Let's start with the elephant in the room. The iPhone 6 is poised to be released sometime in 2014. However, speculation is that its release window will be pushed up to mid-June like it was back in the iPhone 3GS days. While no release date has been officially announced, news of an early release may be welcome news for those sitting on an older iPhone that's been showing its age.



Techradar's unofficial concept video presents some tantalizing predictions of what may be to come for the iPhone. Apple led the charge in the removal of most physical buttons on a cell phone, but even the folks up in Cupertino have remained dedicated to the solitary home button. Techradar proposes the potential future of a

sleek button-less front to the iPhone. Considering the iPhone 5S' advent of Touch ID, it seems plausible that the next iteration of this superstar smartphone may remove the home button entirely!

[CarPlay](#), a feature introduced with iOS 7.1 will most likely take center stage in iOS 8. Since Apple is dependent on third party support for this feature to take off, management was smart to dangle the carrot of future functionality with their latest iOS update. It is unclear how this new feature may manifest a difference in the iPhone 6's hardware, but since iOS 8 will take full advantage of the 64-bit architecture first introduced in iPhone 5S, this may be the hot new bullet point to look for when buying your next vehicle.

If you're not familiar with polymer-dispersed liquid crystal (PDLC) windows, [there's a chance you will be soon](#). Apple filed for a patent that will allow future iPhones to hide the camera, screen and sensors behind opaque glass that can turn clear through a user-prompted electrical charge. In practice, this means the camera on the back won't be visible until the user opens the camera app.

iPad Pro

Missing Plug-in

When it gets hard to make something thinner, what's a hardware manufacturer to do? Make it bigger! The diagonally measured 9.7" screen of the iPad offers features that the relatively tiny iPhone screen can't. Now it seems Apple plans to release a larger iPad that promises to outdo the current smaller version.

The rumored iPad Pro would give users a functional screen surface of a whopping 12.9 inches! Like the iPhone 6, now the iPad is rumored to gain screen real estate by reducing the size of the surrounding bezel. The iPad Pro looks to squash any space between the screen and the edge of the device. And, of course, [the screen is rumored to have a stunning 4K resolution](#).

If the iPhone 6 is released sans home button, it seems logical that the iPad Pro would be shipped sans front-facing buttons as well. Currently there is little in the rumor mill about the fate of the iPad's home button, but don't be surprised come 2015 to find your favorite tablet shipping with nearly edge-to-edge screen.

While the standard mantra in tech is "bigger is better," the news of a larger iPad has garnered its detractors. 9to5mac commenter jrox16 nails it on the head by saying, "Is 9.7" a real problem for anyone? [Making an iPad this large would be solving a problem that doesn't exist for anyone.](#)"

Reports say that [Apple may be pushing the iPad Pro off until early 2015](#). The reasoning is still not confirmed. Some theorize that there is a manufacturing issue that needs to get ironed out. Others speculate that Apple's focus is currently on the rumored iWatch. Perhaps this delay will help Apple streamline the larger iPad to please a larger crowd who are confused by the prospect of a jumbo iPad.

iWatch

Missing Plug-in

The first truly unique device created by Apple since Steve Jobs' passing is the rumored iWatch. Like the mythical tech version of a unicorn, the iWatch has had little confirmable information leak. At the time of this writing, there haven't been any grainy assembly line photos or confirmed Apple orders of identifiable components. Nothing points to Apple making the iWatch save for the fact that Samsung has already upgraded their Galaxy Gear.

Since Samsung has become the testing ground for emerging technologies, it would only make sense for Apple to follow the trailblazing South Korean tech giant and release an elegant revision to Samsung's fledgling first attempts. It would make sense for Apple to release in 2014 so as not to give Samsung the chance to make a third attempt at a smartwatch before any true competition surfaces. ([Sorry Pebble.](#))

While many rumors are extrapolated from what Samsung has already brought to market, there are a few rumors circulating about this new mystery watch.

Most notably, much has been theorized from Apple CEO Tim Cook's position on Nike's board of directors. Some have concluded that this points to the company's potential interest in Nike's Fuelband. Jony Ive, SVP of design at Apple, took a field trip with his team in the mid-2000s to visit watch factories, leaving with an

undisclosed number of sports watches made by Nike.

Since the iWatch hasn't yet been confirmed, and likely won't be until its release, we'll need to wait and see if and when Apple decides to take Samsung on with its version of wearable technology.

Healthbook

Missing Plug-in →

The mobile healthcare and fitness-tracking business is booming. Look at the popularity of the Fitbit, Jawbone UP and Nike FuelBand. Nintendo's latest handheld system even tracks users' steps. Since most Americans are carrying around supercomputers in their pockets, it seems logical that we would let these devices track our fitness progress as well.

Apple appears poised to release Healthbook later this year, potentially as an app in iOS 8. This may also be a big selling feature for the iWatch to capitalize on initially. Since Apple rarely does things halfway, look to Healthbook and iWatch as potentially the most streamlined personal fitness tracker available when it's released.

Rumors have it that Healthbook will track not just movement and steps, but BMI (Body Mass Index) and body fat percentage, heart rate and blood pressure monitoring, sleep tracking and more.

Details are still vague on how exactly Healthbook will track so many user vitals, but the prospect of having body stats available will hopefully mean a fitter, healthier and happier user.

Takeaway

None of these products have been confirmed or announced. So remember that this is all rumor and speculation. The future seems bright for Apple. The advent of wearable smart technology may provide that

needed paradigm shift we've been waiting for since the original iPhone.

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BIO

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Hailing from Chicago and a product of the Illinois public school system, Chaz Wilke is a professional writer who has written for newspaper, TV, radio, video games, blogs, and film. In his spare time, Chaz enjoys hiking and discovering the hidden gems and oddities of Los Angeles. He also juggles.

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